

ChurchCM.com is a much lighter, single-tenant, more streamlined alternative to chmeetings. Here's my (Bumble Ho) detailed findings:

Core Features & Modules

1. Member Management

- Comprehensive member profiles with PII (name, email, phone, birthday, address)
- Status tracking (Active/Inactive)
- Membership levels (Guest, Member, Leader)
- Role assignment capability
- Bulk import via CSV
- Search and filtering by name, email, or phone

2. Family Management

- Groups members by family units
- Tracks family connections and relationships
- Useful for small church pastoral care and family-focused outreach

3. Groups/Small Groups

- Two types: "Small Group" and "Ministry"
- Group leadership assignment
- Membership management with join/remove actions
- Group-specific announcements
- Activity tracking for each group
- Ideal for small church discipleship and ministry organization

4. Courses/Classes

- Three pre-configured types: Sunday School, Baptism, Membership
- Instructor assignment
- Attendance tracking per session with timestamps
- Student enrollment management
- Completion tracking (though not fully implemented in demo)
- Perfect for baptism classes, membership training, and Sunday School

5. Prayer Requests

- Confidentiality levels (Admin/Pastor only vs. Public)
- Status tracking (Pending, In Progress, Answered, Closed)
- Assignment to specific leaders
- Full-text request content
- Great for pastoral prayer ministry and member support

6. Announcements

- Group-specific announcements
- Tied to individual groups/ministries
- Simple but effective communication channel

7. Contact Messages

- Incoming contact form submissions
- Message management
- Marked as "New" when unread

8. Activity Logs

- Complete audit trail of system activities
- Good for accountability and reviewing changes

Administrative Features

Church Settings

- Church name, contact info (phone, email, website)
- Physical address
- Church description/mission statement
- Service hours (flexible format)
- Logo and banner image uploads
- Professional branding customization

Role-Based Access Control Three pre-built roles with the ability to create custom ones:

- **Admin:** Full system access
- **Pastor:** Limited admin access with pastoral privileges (cannot manage roles/permissions)
- **Staff:** Read-only access to most features

Fine-Grained Permissions The system includes 42 distinct permissions covering:

- Members (view, create, update, delete, import, assign roles)
- Families (full CRUD)
- Groups (full CRUD)
- Courses (full CRUD)
- Attendance (full CRUD)
- Prayer Requests (view, create, update, delete, plus special "view confidential" permission)
- Activity Logs (view, delete)
- Roles & Permissions (full management)

- Church Settings (update only)
- Contact Messages (view, update, delete)
- Announcements (full CRUD)

User Experience

Strengths:

- Clean, intuitive dashboard with quick-access widgets
- Consistent navigation sidebar with emoji icons (easy visual scanning)
- Contextual action buttons (Add Member, Enroll in Course, etc.)
- Inline search and filtering throughout
- Related information nicely organized (groups membership on member profiles, students on course pages)
- Professional styling without being overly complex

Simplicity: Unlike ChurchCMS or large ERP systems, ChurchCM avoids:

- Accounting/giving modules
- Advanced scheduling
- Complex financial management
- Bloated feature sets
- Steep learning curve

Best Use Cases for Small Churches

✅ Perfect for:

- Churches with 50-500 active members
- Organizations wanting simple member directory
- Small group/ministry coordination
- Basic discipleship tracking (via courses)
- Prayer request management
- Staff coordination (with roles)
- Churches needing basic branding/settings but not full website builder

⚠️ Limitations for small churches:

- No giving/donations module (would need separate tool like Giving or PayPal)
- No calendar/event scheduling
- No visitor tracking or guest management
- Limited reporting capabilities (no attendance trends, giving reports)
- No mobile app (though UI is responsive)
- No integration with church websites or social media
- No group messaging/communication tools

Verdict

Simon's product hits a **sweet spot for small churches** that want:

- Easy member management without overkill
- Simple group/ministry organization
- Prayer request handling with confidentiality
- Basic course/class management
- Role-based access control
- Clean, modern interface

The system is **significantly simpler** than ChMeetings or other ERP solutions while still providing essential church management features. It would work exceptionally well for independent churches, plants, or ministries under 500 people that don't need full financial/giving integration.

The permission system is particularly well-designed for small churches—allowing flexibility to create roles like "Children's Ministry Leader" or "Small Group Coordinator" with granular permissions, without being overly complex.

Comparison Summary: If ChMeetings is a "Swiss Army knife" for bigger churches, ChurchCM is the "reliable pocketknife" for small congregations.

NOTE 1: ChurchCM is (very likely) a fork of ChurchCRM, which is the open-source project at <https://github.com/ChurchCRM/CRM> (The project has an MIT license, which requires proper attribution)ⁱ. Therefore, if churches use Simon's system, he will need to provide proper attribution so that it won't affect us in the long run. If he indeed built on this open-source project, it would be a better option for the clients rather than building everything himself, and then the clients would be locked in on a technical debt that they cannot pay in the long run.

NOTE 2: ChurchCM has a very basic web page for the church also (see <https://demo.churchcm.com>) but it's not a full web content management system. This is the same with chmeetings (<https://rpc.chmeetings.com>).

Simon could quickly and easily build a hosting company for small churches and charge \$15-30/month per church with 60% margin using ChurchCMⁱⁱ.

END NOTES

ⁱ What I found so far (Suggestive but not definitive proof): From the demo system, I observed:

- Laravel-style URL routing (typical of ChurchCRM)
- Nearly identical permission structure with 42 specific permissions (this is very detailed and specific)
- Role system with Admin/Pastor/Staff (ChurchCRM's exact structure)
- Identical feature names and organization
- Same data model (Members → Families → Groups → Courses)

ⁱⁱ The model based on:

- Create Docker containerized ChurchCRM packages
- Offer automated one-click deployment to AWS/DigitalOcean
- Provide automatic backups, SSL certificates, updates
- Charge \$15-30/month per church
- Cost: 2-3 weeks dev, 60% margins